

things on their own. Approach a school that teaches you how to work with the tools rather than just teaches you the tools.

2. Any guarantee of salary packages, getting jobs, internships and placements should sound alarms. There are a lot of 'Diploma-mills' cropping up in every nook-and-corner of the country trying to make a quick buck off kids who are just excited about gaming and parents who are worried about salaries. A lot of such institutes even end up hiring their own alumni for meager pay-scales. A good school will have enough reputation in the market to not need to shout from the rooftops. Check their alumni and their achievements. They expect you to be good enough to score internships and jobs on their own. Remember, there is no scarcity of jobs, only scarcity of right people for the jobs.
3. Avoid schools which rely a lot on theory. You can get that anywhere for free, even YouTube. The job of a good Game Design school is to not to teach you but rather provide conditions for you to learn in and at times, even pressure you. There is a lot more to Game Design than just design, there is people management, project management, ego management and so much more. All of this will make you ready to work on a live project in a Studio.

Alternatively, you could go head-on and join as a trainee or a Game Tester and work your way up the ladder. That gives a totally different kind of conditioning and working style. And relies heavily on learning using low risk live projects and proving your mettle.

And lastly, you could go lone wolf, where you try to do as many things as you can on your own (with some collaboration) and release games on your own too. This involves a lot of investment and patience and it will keep you hungry for a while before your hard work starts paying off. In any case, all three approaches rely heavily on self learning and differ only on the basis of how much time and money you invest and what you expect from yourself.

Future Opportunities – Is the sky really the limit?

So, you are a Game Designer now. Where do you go from here? Well, two things come into play at this stage. The first is knowing that you will never stop learning as a Designer. The second is knowing what you want from your career. Do you see yourself making this unique game no one else seems to have made? Go ahead, gather a team, inspire others with your idea and start a studio. Get a prototype running and approach a publisher (in the same